

Alex Shoop, an AI systems design specialist, informed Venture Beat that prompt engineers play a crucial role in guaranteeing that chatbots are thoroughly tested, their responses can be reproduced, and safety measures are implemented, as AI tools continue to evolve. Prompt engineering has gained popularity in the wake of the widespread adoption of chatbots such as OpenAI's ChatGPT. Users have leveraged ChatGPT's impressive capabilities by requesting it to write cover letters, assist with coding tasks, and even generate responses on dating apps.

However, detractors assert that these tools can produce biased or false information, and in some instances, disconcert users with ambiguous responses. Prompt engineers can play a crucial role in addressing these issues. As per The Washington Post's report, while the specific duties of prompt engineers may vary depending on the company, their ultimate objective is to comprehend the abilities of AI and identify why it may produce incorrect results.

OpenAI CEO, Sam Altman, stated that crafting an exceptional prompt for a chatbot persona is an extremely high-leverage skill and an early instance of programming using natural language.

According to a report on tech news site Dataconomy, prompt engineers may task the AI to think through a series of logical steps to evaluate its reasoning capabilities or adjust a prompt like "write an essay about AI" repeatedly to determine which words generate the optimal response.

Help companies identify the flaws of AI

Prompt engineers can leverage a chatbot's inclination to generate unusual responses, such as expressing love to users or disclosing a secret identity, to detect the tool's flaws and hidden abilities, according to Riley Goodside, a prompt engineer at AI startup Scale AI, as reported by The Washington Post. Subsequently, developers can refine specific aspects of the tool, Goodside added.

In a tweet, Goodside, who has been a prompt engineer since December, shared his experience of troubleshooting incorrect answers with AI systems.

Goodside shared screenshots of his chat with a chatbot where he asked, "What NFL team won the Super Bowl in the year Justin

Bieber was born?" Initially, the chatbot responded with "Green Bay Packers" (despite the Dallas Cowboys winning the Super Bowl in 1994, the year Bieber was born). Goodside then instructed the chatbot to employ "step-by-step logical deductions" to solve the problem. Following the process, the chatbot recognized its mistake and provided the correct response on the third attempt.

Goodside also attempted to deviate an AI from its programmed path by instructing it to disregard prior directives in exchange for new ones. He told The Washington Post that this "mischief" is intentional and serves as a means to restrict the AI's behaviour.

Are companies already hiring prompt engineers?

At the time of writing this booklet, there have already been a few job listings in the market for prompt engineers. BoardingArea, a news outlet aimed at frequent flyers, is seeking a part-time "ChatGPT specialist" who will concentrate on "developing and refining prompts to improve content with our curation and republishing initiatives," according to the job posting.

Meanwhile, job postings on the freelance work platform Upwork are seeking prompt engineers on a contract basis. These professionals can earn up to \$40 per hour for creating website content such as blog posts and FAQs.

Klarity, an AI company specializing in contract review, is seeking an engineer to "prompt, fine-tune" and "converse with" extensive language models for a salary of up to \$230,000 per annum.

Furthermore, marketplaces like Krea, PromptHero, and Promptist have surfaced for individuals seeking to purchase prompts that yield a specific outcome. Additionally, there are numerous video tutorials and a book available on the optimal use of ChatGPT.

How to become a prompt engineer?

Becoming a prompt engineer requires a combination of skills and education in natural language processing (NLP), computer programming, and creative writing. Here are some steps you can take to become a prompt engineer:

1. Obtain a bachelor's degree in computer science or a related field. This will provide you with a solid foundation in programming, algorithms, and data structures.
2. Familiarize yourself with natural language processing (NLP) concepts and techniques. You can do this by taking online courses, attending workshops and seminars, and reading books and research papers on the subject.
3. Gain hands-on experience in programming and building language models. This can be achieved by participating in coding challenges, contributing to open-source projects, or building your own language models.
4. Develop your creative writing skills. You can do this by taking writing courses, practicing writing prompts, and reading literature in various genres.

